

Keyboards FEBRUARY 2006

Logitech Standard Keyboard 9.80	Logitech Internet Keyboard 12.81	Logitech G15 Gaming Keyboard 26.04	Microsoft Comfort Curve Keyboard 2000 10.61	Tech-com SSD-KB-990 20.48	Tech-Com SSD-KB-880 15.79	Zebronic ZEB-K500L 5.95	Zebronic ZEB-K121 8.72
3.5	3	4.5	4.5	3.75	2.75	3.25	3
Nil	8	35	10	49	18	Nil	12
Nil	Play/Pause, volume, mute	Play/Pause, mute, stop, next, previous, volume knob	Play/Pause, volume, mute	Play/Pause, stop, volume, launch media player, next, previous track, mute	Play/Pause, stop, previous, next, volume	Nil	Play/Pause, volume, mute
Nil	IE launch, search, Favo- rites, e-mail	Nil	IE launch, search, back, forward, e-mail	Back, forward, stop, refresh, Favorites, search, e-mail	Back, forward, stop, refresh, Favorites, search, e-mail	Nil	IE launch, e-mail, Favorites
Nil	Nil	18 programmable keys in three modes giving a total of 54 combina- tions, gaming mode switch, backlight toggle switch	Calculator	Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Calendar, cut, copy, paste, mark, back, forward, applica- tion switch, close, scroll pad	My Computer, Calculator	Backlight on/off switch	My Computer, Calculator, sleep
4	4	4	6	4	4	6	6
4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
6	6	Yes (two)	6	6	6	6	6
PS2	PS2	USB	USB	PS2	PS2	USB	PS2
None	None	None	None	None	None	None	None
None	None	Programmable display LCD	None	None	None	None	None
33.75	32.18	33.75	26.55	30.92	27.27	21.78	27.86
4.25	3.5	4	4	4	4	4	3.5
3.75	3.5	4	3.5	3.5	3.5	2.5	3.5
3.5	3.5	4	2.75	3	3.5	3	3.25
3.5	3.5	4	3.25	3.5	3.5	3	3.5
4.25	3.5	4	0	3.75	0	0	0
385	595	4995	1220	999	499	950	325
12.99	8.40	1.00	4.10	5.01	10.02	5.26	15.38
56.54	53.39	60.79	41.25	56.40	53.08	32.99	51.95



Our Verdict

Minimalistic on features, these sets are for people on shoestring budgets, and offer more than what is expected of them. Taking price into the equation, two wired desktop combos are a hairsbreadth away from taking the top honours: the Genius EasyTouch Optical II and Giga-byte's GKM-10 both make it to the top spot.

We do think the Genius Easy-Touch Optical II has an edge when it comes to features; however, if you value ergonomics, you should opt for the Giga-byte GKM-10 combo set. The Logitech Internet Pro Desktop black is expensive and this affects its final score, however if you can stretch your budget, this set makes for a great black desktop combo.

CORDLESS DESKTOP COMBOS

Features

The cordless desktop combo category consisted of some of the best devices we received for this test. This category was largely dominated by Logitech, with six products of the ten we reviewed. Genius, iBall and BenQ were the other brands that had cordless desktop combos.

We were bowled over by Logitech's products—they have some of the best finishing we have seen thus far. Their new range of products is sleek, aesthetically appealing, and sets new standards in the design department.

The Cordless Desktop S510 Media Remote features a thin,

flat, sleek looking keyboard designed specially to go with an LCD monitor, an optical mouse with horizontal scroll, and a media centre remote control. The set comes bundled with a Media Center application called MediaLife, which allows easy access to media files on the computer—photos, music and videos. Other notable features include, a Zoom button to zoom in and out of pictures, Excel files, etc. Also, the little USB receiver makes it possible to very easily connect to a notebook. If you can do without the media centre remote, Logitech has the Cordless Desktop S510.

The diNovo Media Desktop Laser is another innovative product from Logitech that caught our fancy. It has a keyboard, a separate numeric